instantaneous. Ghur itself surely did not remain immune to Islam and particularly Perso-Islamicate cultural forms given the continuous presence of both in neighboring Sistan and Zamindawar – presences beginning in the eighth century and continuing uninterrupted into the twelfth: on the heels of the Arab-Umayyad forays of the late seventh century, the entry of the Arab-Abbasids there engendered volatile Kharijite reactions in the eighth–ninth centuries, emerging particularly from Sistan.[79] Thereafter the Saljuqs and Ghaznavids continued the influx of Islam-affiliated ruling ideologies and imperial presences into these regions.

During the first two decades of the eleventh century, the infiltration of some form of Islamic religio-cultural presence in Ghur only increased. According to C. E. Bosworth, the Ghaznavids' own expediency in solidifying their hold over the important commercial emporium and intellectual center of Nishapur was instrumental in this process[80]: although Maḥmud Ghaznavi's father Sabuktigin had been a supporter of the Karramiyya, this populist sect's appeal to and rousing of the city's skilled labor groups – not to mention their increasing antipathy toward Nishapur's more orthodox *madhhab*s – required their removal to the hinterlands. Bosworth proposed that the sultan deputed the Karramiyya to the outlying areas of Ghur and perhaps elsewhere, where their notorious proselytizing zeal would find fertile ground among rural and transhumant/nomadic–pastoralist populations (cf. also Chapter 4). In the end, however, Mahmud Ghaznavi's dislodging of the Karramiyya from Nishapur and their entry into Ghur would have been only the most direct and documentable exposure to Islam for the Ghuris, who were in all likelihood already exposed to Islam's ideologies and religio-cultural mores from at least the preceding century or more.[81]

Within modern nomadic societies, anthropological studies have long noted a "poverty of ritual activities" – and specifically their traces, that is, ritual structures: nomadic life was structured around annual migrations and temporary settlements rather than the observation of feasts, fasts, and all-encompassing calendrical systems, especially if the latter were unsynchronized with seasonal transhumance.[82] In light of this overarching nomadic tendency, it is plausible that, given the pre-imperial Shansabanis' transhumance and/or nomadism, demonstrations of Islamic adherence would be difficult to recuperate, as would many other social and cultural aspects of their activities. Nevertheless, even if Islam co-existed with the region's "indigenous paganism," it is not implausible that some Ghuris, and particularly the Shansabanis' pre-imperial ancestors, had already been exposed to Islam for at least 200 years prior to the twelfth century, by which time a predisposition toward this religious and cultural ethos could have solidified.

By the beginning of the twelfth century and the construction of the Da Qadi *minar*, the advantages of some degree of adherence to Islam –